

# The SAP/SI Challenge Checklist

Twelve gates for every product, licence, customisation and SI work package

Attach this page to every proposed SAP product, module, licence, customisation or SI change order. A gate closes only when the evidence in the right-hand column has been seen.

| #  | Gate          | Question                                      | Evidence that closes the gate                                                                 | Seen                     |
|----|---------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1  | REQUIREMENT   | What exact business problem are we solving?   | Business requirement signed by the process owner, with volumes and measurable benefit.        | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2  | STANDARD      | What SAP standard capability was evaluated?   | Fit-gap against our release and edition, with SAP documentation references.                   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3  | CONFIGURATION | Why can configuration not solve it?           | Configuration options tested and the reason each failed.                                      | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4  | EXTENSION     | Why can supported extensibility not solve it? | Assessment of key-user, developer and side-by-side options, with clean core level.            | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5  | INTEGRATION   | Why is integration required?                  | Data flow design, system of record per object, interface owner.                               | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 6  | CUSTOM        | Why is custom code required?                  | Justification, owner, clean core level, test and retirement plan.                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 7  | PRODUCT       | Why is another SAP product required?          | Proof that owned products and standard scope cannot meet the need.                            | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 8  | LICENCE       | What exact licence is required?               | Licence metric, quantity, term and the clause that grants the right.                          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 9  | COST          | What is the five-year TCO?                    | Full cost model including integration, testing, support and consumption; seven-year view too. | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 10 | RISK          | What new dependency does this create?         | Operational, technical, commercial and skills dependencies, with mitigations.                 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 11 | EXIT          | How do we remove it later?                    | Exit steps, data return, notice periods and cost.                                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 12 | EVIDENCE      | Show us the documentation.                    | Documents, not slides: SAP documentation, contract clauses, test results.                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## EVIDENCE REQUIRED | Who confirms which gates

- Gates 1-3: owner-side process lead (not the proposer).
- Gates 4-7 and 10: architecture / design authority.
- Gates 8, 9 and 11: finance, procurement and legal.
- Gate 12: steering committee - documents, not slides.

## RED FLAG | The sentence that reopens every gate

"SAP cannot do that." Ask: which standard process, in which release, was tested - and where is the SAP documentation?